



UNIVERSITY OF AMSTERDAM
Amsterdam Business School

Ethics and the Future of Business

Session 2

Consumption: About Meaning

Professor Willemijn van Dolen & Sybille Yumeaux



Structure

1) Recap

2) Articles

- Gupta, A., Eilert, M., & Gentry, J. W. (2024). Meaningful Consumption. *Journal of Macromarketing*, 44(3), 637-652. <https://doi.org/10.1177/02761467241236485>
- Sheth, Sethia, & Srinivas (2011). Mindful consumption: A Customer-Centric Approach to Sustainability. *Journal of the Academy Marketing Science*, 39, 21–39. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11747-010-0216-3>
- White, Habib, & Hardisty (2019). How to SHIFT Consumer Behaviors to be More Sustainable: A Literature Review and Guiding Framework. *Journal of Marketing*. 83(3): 22-49. doi:10.1177/0022242919825649

BREAK

3) SHIFT article interactive session with Sybille Yumeaux

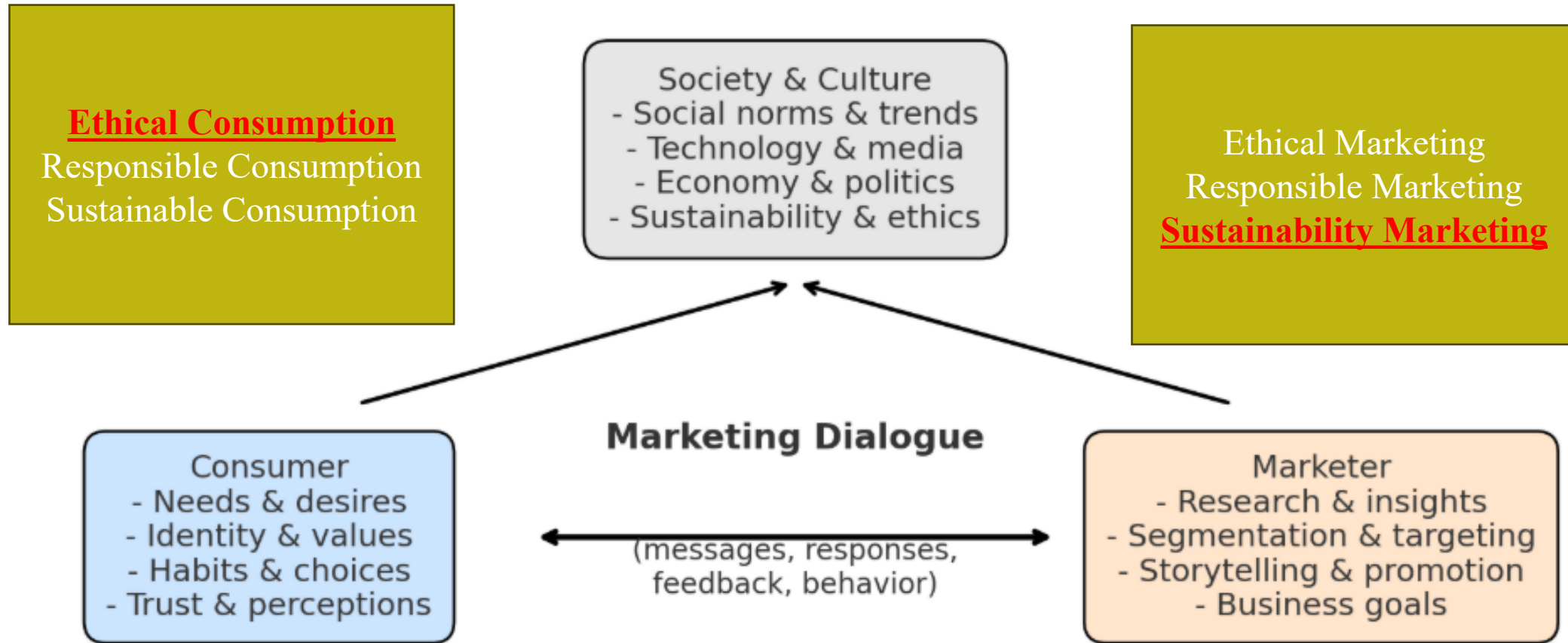


Recap





The Two Sides of Marketing





Cheaper





Cheaper



Gebak, desserts en koekjes



AARDBEIENIJS

Plantaardige...

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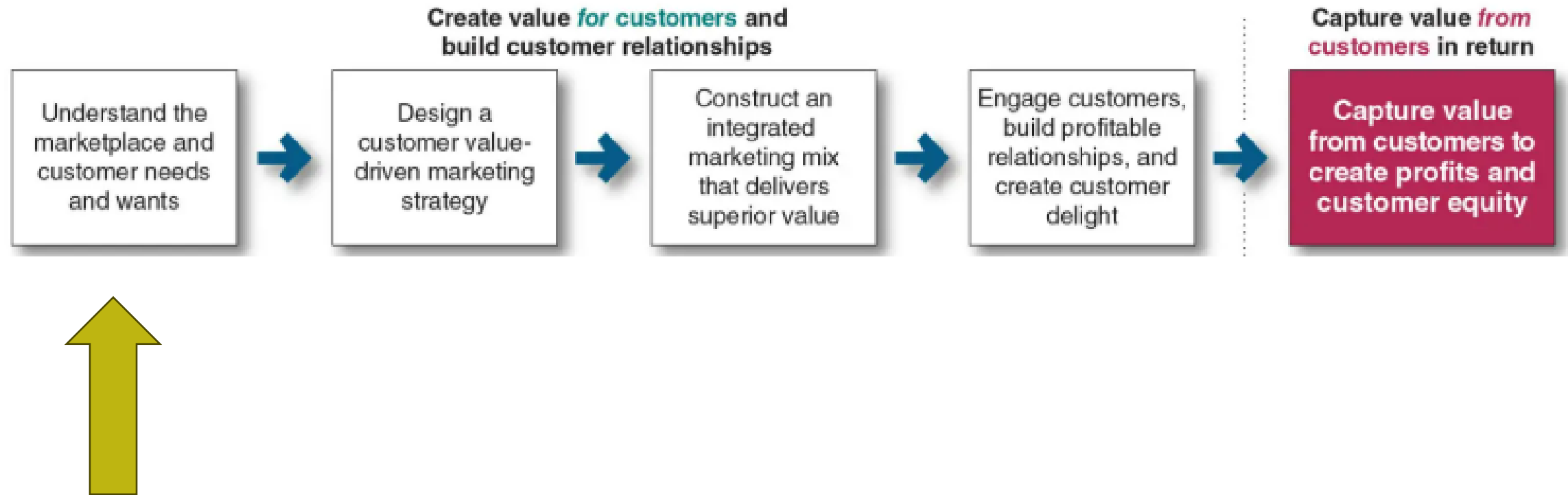
VANILLEIJS

Softijs met vanillesmaak

€1,29



The Marketing Process: Creating + Capturing Customer





Behavior & Actions: Why do we consume?

Research Article

Meaningful Consumption

Aditya Gupta¹ , Meike Eilert² and James W. Gentry²

Abstract
While consumers frequently seek meaning through their marketplace interactions, a comprehensive understanding of meaningful consumption is conspicuously absent from marketing literature. Such insight would notably benefit macromarketing scholars who aim to evaluate the implications of consumer purchasing decisions on quality of life. Addressing this gap, our study employs 40 in-depth interviews to arrive at the phenomenological essence of meaningful consumption. We discover that meaningful consumption comprises three key themes—rejuvenation, expansion, and consolidation—accompanied by seven related sub-themes: repair and reconnection; intellectual, pragmatic, and relational expansion; and crystallization and contextualization. Our overarching framework enriches macromarketing theory by virtue of its ability to accommodate a large variety of meaningful consumption experiences while simultaneously enhancing existing discourse on the eudaimonic aspects of consumption.

Keywords
meaningful consumption, quality of life, qualitative research, depth interview, eudaimonia

Consumers often make purchase and consumption decisions for reasons that go beyond utilitarian or hedonic concerns (Levy 1959). These can include the desire to seek refuge in nature (Arnould and Price 1993; Canniford and Shankar 2013), the aspiration to improve oneself (Latour and Latour 2010; Rindfleisch 2005), the quest for community and belonging (Schouten and McAlexander 1995), or the willingness to embrace challenges (Celsi, Rose, and Leigh 1993; Scott, Cayla, and Cova 2017). These examples also illustrate that consumers are willing to invest time, effort, and resources to pursue impact consumer behavior (Dodds, Jaud, and Melnyk 2021; Mead and Williams 2023; Puente-Diaz and Cavazos-Arroyo 2021), the insights from such research tend to be limited to specific consumption contexts such as gift-giving or advertising. Consequently, marketing discourse continues to lack an overarching framework for understanding meaningful consumption that can accommodate a variety of consumption contexts. To that end, this research focuses on a critical question that remains unanswered: How do consumers experience meaningful consumption?

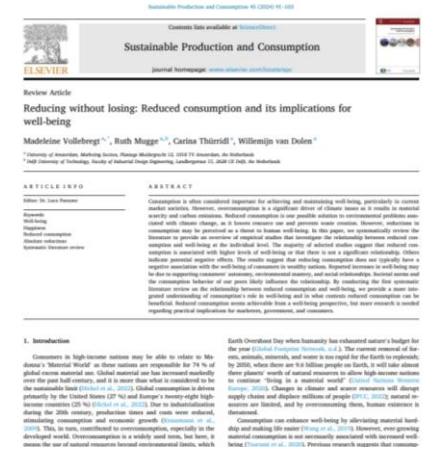
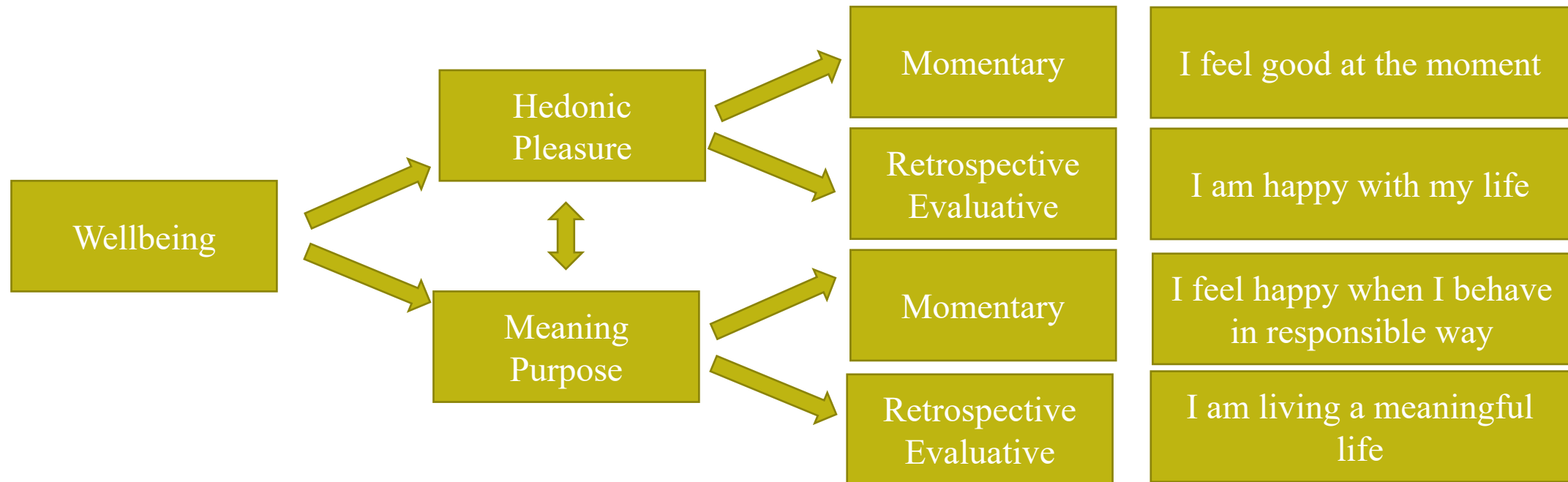
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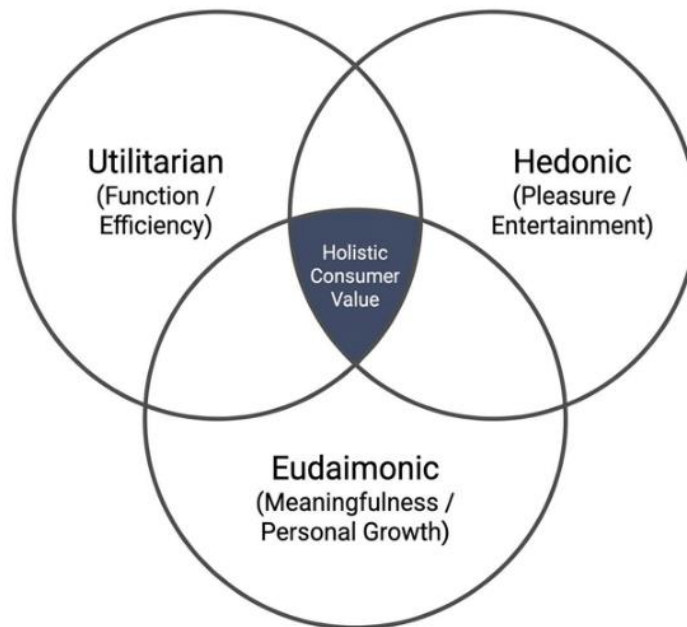


Well-being



A Tripartite Conceptualization of Consumer Value

Purchases are rarely one-dimensional. A product can be classified by its dominant value, but true holistic value integrates all three dimensions.





Fun

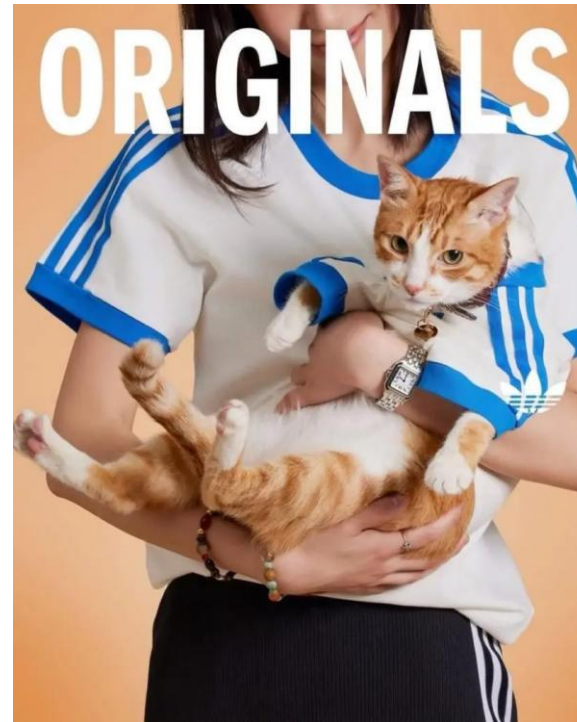


Table 2. Meaningful Consumption: Central Themes and Sub-Themes.

Central Theme	Definition	Sub-Theme and Definition
Rejuvenation	The extent to which a purchase can facilitate a sense of renewal within consumers.	<i>Repair:</i> The extent to which a purchase can help consumers heal by allowing them a temporary escape from common stressors and strains. <i>Reconnection:</i> The extent to which a purchase can help renew important relationships between consumers and close others in their lives.
Expansion	The extent to which a purchase can help consumers grow in one or more aspects.	<i>Intellectual Expansion:</i> The extent to which a purchase can help consumers increase topic knowledge and broaden their intellectual horizons. <i>Pragmatic Expansion:</i> The extent to which a purchase can help consumers acquire or refine one or more practical skills. <i>Relational Expansion:</i> The extent to which a purchase can help consumers form new relationships or deepen existing ones.
Consolidation	The extent to which a purchase can provide consumers with a deeper and richer understanding about themselves.	<i>Crystallization:</i> The extent to which a purchase can help consumers gain a stronger understanding of their true selves via intentional decision-making or serendipitous moments. <i>Contextualization:</i> The extent to which a purchase can help consumers better understand their position relative to larger elements such as the passage of time, the world around them, and the grand scheme of things.



Kesbeke



Consume

- 1) Functional: Best pickles in terms of quality, bite, taste
- 2) Hedonic: Fun, Series
- 3) Meaningful: Family-business, around for 75 years, take good care of employees, honesty, transparency, authenticity, gifts, merchandise



Rejuvenate: Repair: Treat Yourself





Rejuvenate: Repair: Treat Yourself

REVIEW

“Kesbeke
Smuluitjes zijn
het geheime
ingrediënt van
mijn broodje
glimlach!”

Marcel (32 jaar / kok)



Kesbeke Al E

Welkom bij Kesbeke!

REVIEW

“Kesbeke
Smuluitjes are
the secret
ingredient of
my sandwich
smile!”

Marcel (32 years old / chef)





Rejuvenate: Reconnect: Tour



[Webshop](#) [Our little shop](#) [CSR](#) [News](#) [Availability](#) [Commercial](#) [FR](#) [THE](#) [AND](#)

[HOME](#) [OUR FAMILY BUSINESS](#) [THE TASTIEST PICKLES!](#) [GASTRONOMY](#)   

FACTORY TOURS VERY POPULAR



The guided tours of our beautiful Kesbeke factory are currently extremely popular.

So popular, in fact, that it's currently no longer possible to book a tour. We think that's a real shame—but hey, we need to make time to pickle. Want to experience the Kesbeke atmosphere? Then come visit our

FIND A PRODUCT

CATEGORIES

- Pickles
- Onions
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- Jonnie & Oos
- All products

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Our pickles are preserved according to a family recipe.

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Rejuvenate: Reconnect: Gifts



HOME

ZUUR

OLIE EN BALSAMICO

VIS

WORST EN KAAS

SPECIALITEITEN EN CADEAUTJES

ZELF INMAKEN

EVENEMENTEN EN RONDELEIDINGEN





Expansion: Pragmatic: Gastronomy and Recipes

The screenshot shows the homepage of the Familie Kesbeke website. The top navigation bar includes links for 'Webshop', 'Ons winkeltje', 'MVO', 'Nieuws', 'Beschikbaarheid', 'Zakelijk', and language options 'FR', 'DE', 'EN'. Below this is a secondary navigation bar with 'HOME', 'ONS FAMILIEBEDRIJF', 'LEKKERSTE TAFELZUUR!', 'GASTRONOMIE', and social media icons for YouTube, Instagram, and Facebook. The main visual is a kitchen scene with two men, one in a chef's uniform and another in a blue shirt and apron. Overlaid on the image is the text 'GASTRONOMIE EN RECEPTEN' and 'TOPCHEFS WERKEN MET KESBEKE'. A QR code is visible on a screen in the background. A green text box at the bottom contains a message about top chefs using their products. A chatbot notification for 'Kesbeke AI Bot' is also present.

Webshop Ons winkeltje MVO Nieuws Beschikbaarheid Zakelijk FR DE EN

HOME ONS FAMILIEBEDRIJF LEKKERSTE TAFELZUUR! GASTRONOMIE

Familie Kesbeke
SINDS 1948
FIJNE TAFELZUREN

GASTRONOMIE EN RECEPTEN
TOPCHEFS WERKEN
MET KESBEKE

Topchefs werken graag met onze producten.
En daar zijn we maar wat trots op!

Wij staan voor kwaliteit, traditie en innovatie. Topchefs kiezen vaak voor onze producten. Wow, daar zijn we supertrots op! Kwaliteit is het hart van elke culinaire creatie. Een chef-kok is zo goed als de ingrediënten waarmee hij of zij werkt. Kesbeke begrijpt dit principe als geen ander. We hanteren strenge normen voor de selectie van onze verse ingrediënten, waardoor ze

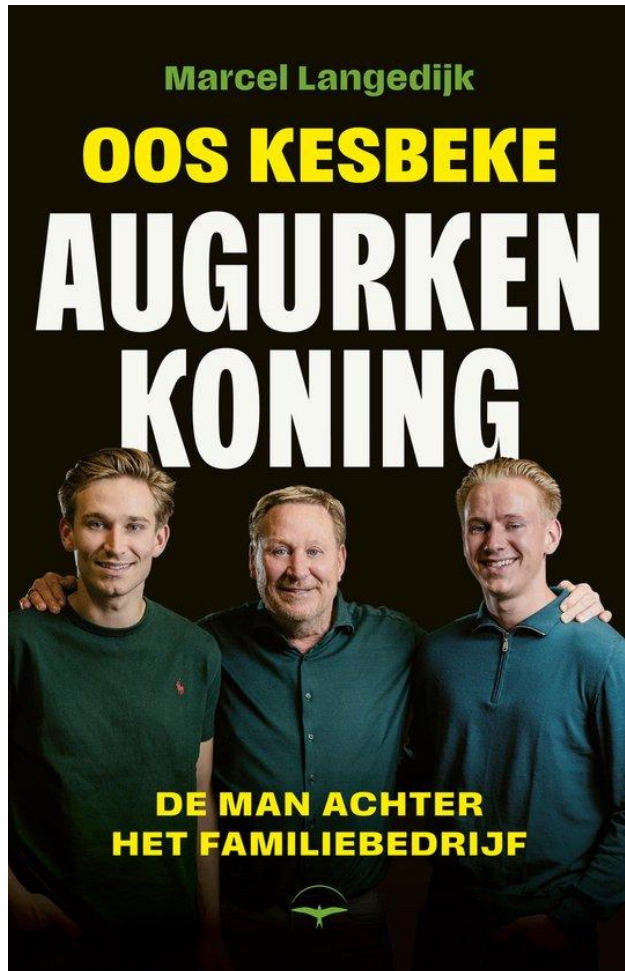
Kesbeke AI Bot
Welkom bij Kesbeke!
Meer weten over wowzerz.chat?

Expansion: Pragmatic: Pickle Yourself





Expansion: Intellectual: Book





Expansion: Intellectual: Difference Cucumber & Pickle



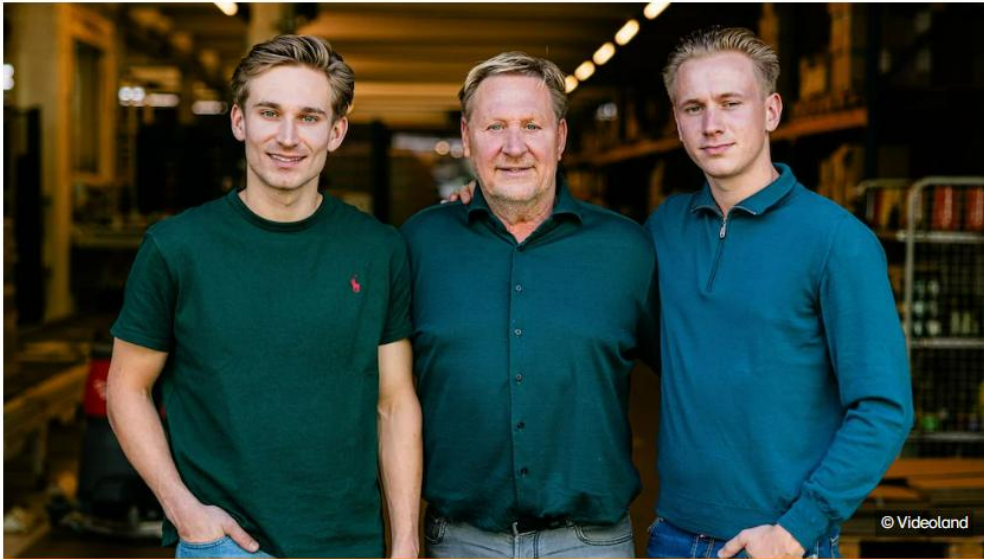


Expansion: Relational: TV Series

GradiOos success

**Is there a new season of The Pickle King coming?
Oos Kesbeke reveals a little too much.**

By RTL Boulevard · June 2, 2025 · Amended: June 2, 2025

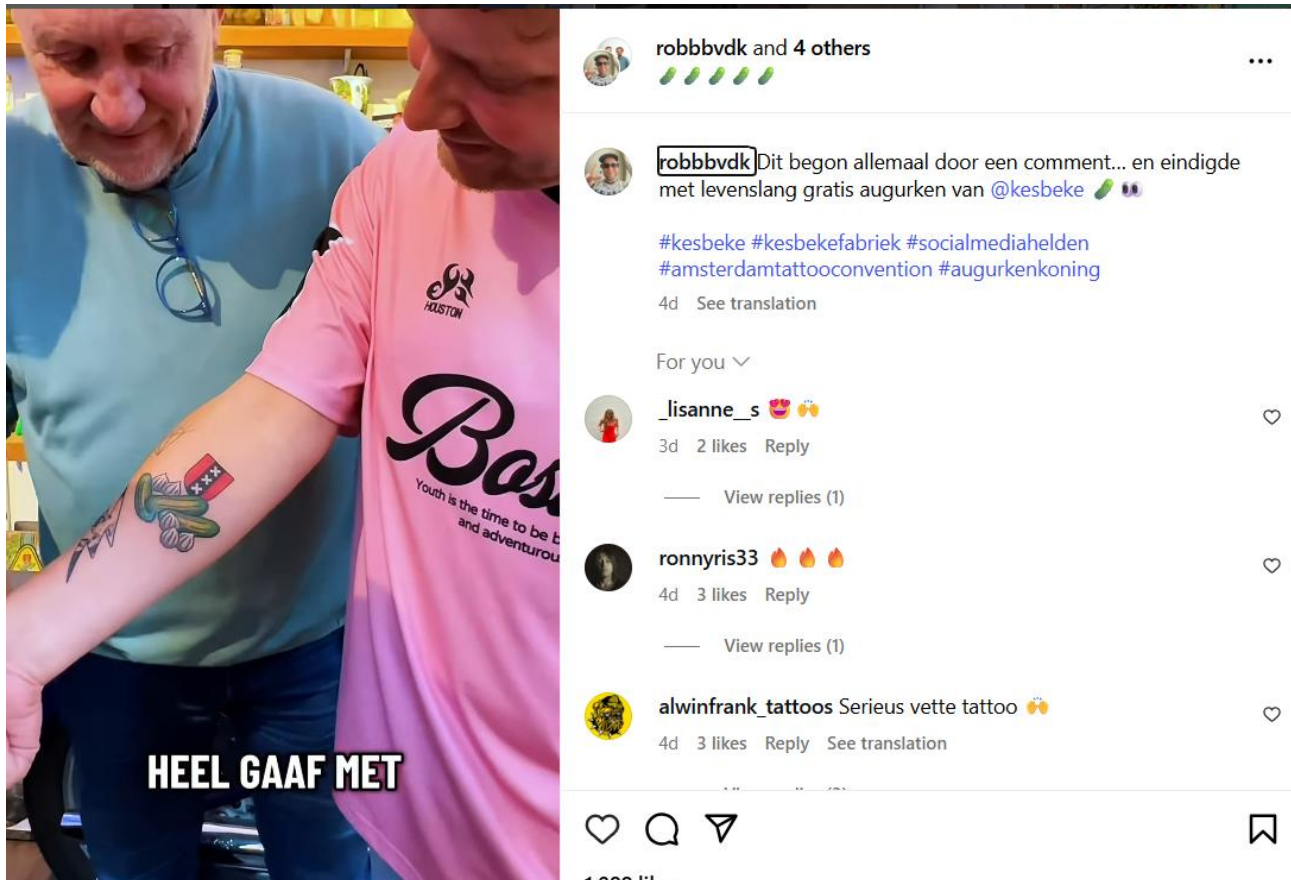


RTL Boulevard

Oos Kesbeke (66), known for his work on "De Augurkenkoning," inadvertently let slip something about the future of his reality series on "De Coen & Sander Show" Monday morning. A new season seems imminent.



Consolidation: Crystallization: Tattoo





Consolidation: Crystallization: Tattoo





Consolidation: Crystallization: Merchandise



Consolidation: Contextualization: Family Feeling



Kesbeke AI Bot



Welkom bij Kesbeke!

[Meer weten over wowzerz.chat?](#)



Rejuvenation Repair/Expansion Relational/Consolidation Crystal.



Replika AI companions can be customised to suit the relationship needs of users. (Supplied: Luka/Replika)

abc.net.au/news/replika-users-fell-in-love-with-th...



Share article

AI Companions Reduce Loneliness

JULIAN DE FREITAS
ZELIHA OGUZ-UGURALP
AHMET KAAH UGURALP
STEFANO PUNTONI

Chatbots are now able to engage in sophisticated conversations with consumers in the domain of relationships, providing a potential coping solution to widescale societal loneliness. Behavioral research provides little insight into whether these applications (apps) are effective at alleviating loneliness. We address this question by focusing on “artificial intelligence (AI) companions”: apps designed to provide consumers with synthetic interaction partners. Study 1 examines user reviews of AI companion apps and finds correlational evidence suggesting that these apps help alleviate loneliness. Study 2 finds that AI companions successfully alleviate loneliness on par only with interacting with another person and more than other activities such as watching YouTube videos. Moreover, consumers underestimate the degree to which AI companions improve their loneliness. Study 3 uses a longitudinal design and finds that an AI companion consistently provides momentary reductions in loneliness after use over the course of a week. Study 4 provides evidence that both the chatbots’ performance and, especially, whether it makes users feel heard, explain reductions in loneliness. Study 5 provides an additional robustness check for the loneliness-alleviating benefits of AI companions and shows that self-disclosure and distraction alone do not explain AI companions’ effectiveness.

Keywords: generative AI, chatbots, loneliness, large language models, artificial intelligence, AI companion

Julian De Freitas (jdefreitas@hbs.edu) is Assistant Professor in the Marketing Unit at Harvard Business School, Soldiers Field, Morgan Hall 161, Boston, MA 02163, USA. Zeliha Oguuz-Ugurulp (zelha@marsdata.co) is co-founder and research lead at Marsdata Academic, Universieler District, 1597th Street No:3, Interior Door No:127, Cankaya, Ankara 06800, Turkey. Ahmet Kaan Uguralp (ahmetkaan@marsdata.co) is co-founder and research lead at Marsdata Academic, Universieler District, 1597th Street No:3, Interior Door No:127, Cankaya, Ankara 06800, Turkey. Stefano Puntoni (puntoni@wharton.upenn.edu) is the Sebastian S. Knease Professor of Marketing at The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, 760 Jon M. Huntsman Hall, 3730 Walnut Street, Philadelphia, PA 19104, USA. Please address correspondence to Julian De Freitas. This research was generously funded by the Wharton Behavioral Lab. The authors sincerely thank the Wharton Behavioral Lab for its support. [Supplementary materials](#) are included in the [web appendix](#) accompanying the online version of this article.

Editors: Andrew T. Stephen and Oleg Urminsky

Associate Editor: Thomas P. Novak

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Thanks to advances in “generative artificial intelligence (AI)” algorithms, AI companion applications (apps) are now commercially available. These apps utilize AI to engage in interactions of a personal nature, providing emotional support and companionship. AI companions are synthetic interaction partners that build and maintain personal relationship bonds with users (Darcy et al. 2021) by offering empathy and emotional support (Provoost et al. 2017). Unlike most AI apps that help with short-term tasks in an objective/neutral manner (e.g., customer service agents or educational tutors), AI companions are designed to build and maintain long-term emotional relationships in a taskless, empathic, and caring manner.

Modern AI companion systems are powered by recent advancements in large language models (LLMs), such as OpenAI’s generative pretrained transformer (GPT). Although most consumers today are used to task-based AI assistants powered by such models (e.g., ChatGPT), it is important to note that these AI assistants are fine-tuned variants of an underlying foundational model (in this case, GPT). Just as a foundational model can be fine-tuned for

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INTERVIEW IRIS SOMER

Professor of psychiatry believes in AI for mental health care: 'I am amazed by the empathetic advice'





Consolidate

MARKETING SCIENCE
CELEBRATING 30 YEARS

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Brands: The Opiate of the Nonreligious Masses?

Ron Shachar

Faculty of Management, Tel Aviv University, 69979 Tel Aviv, Israel; and Fuqua School of Business,
Duke University, Durham, North Carolina 27708, shachar@duke.edu

Tülin Erdem

Stern School of Business, New York University, New York, New York 10012, terdem@stern.nyu.edu

Keisha M. Cutright, Gavan J. Fitzsimons

Fuqua School of Business, Duke University, Durham, North Carolina 27708
[kmw25@duke.edu, gavan@duke.edu]

Are brands the “new religion”? Practitioners and scholars have been intrigued by the possibility, but strong theory and empirical evidence supporting the existence of a relationship between brands and religion is scarce. In what follows, we argue and demonstrate that religiosity is indeed related to “brand reliance,” i.e., the degree to which consumers prefer branded goods over unbranded goods or goods without a well-known national brand.

We theorize that brands and religiosity may serve as substitutes for one another because both allow individuals to express their feelings of self-worth. We provide support for this substitution hypothesis with U.S. state-level data (field study) as well as individual-level data where religiosity is experimentally primed (study 1) or measured as a chronic individual difference (study 2). Importantly, studies 1 and 2 demonstrate that the relationship between religiosity and brand reliance only exists in product categories in which brands enable consumers to express themselves (e.g., clothes). Moreover, studies 3 and 4 demonstrate that the expression of self-worth is an important factor underlying the negative relationship.

Key words: brands; brand reliance; brand choice; religion; self-expression; self-worth

History: Received: February 3, 2010; accepted: June 16, 2010; Eric Bradlow served as the editor-in-chief and Robert Meyer served as associate editor for this article. Published online in *Articles in Advance* September 24, 2010.

J C R

Journal of Consumer Research

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Journal of Consumer Research

Article Contents

Abstract

Author notes

Supplementary data

JOURNAL ARTICLE ACCEPTED MANUSCRIPT

Brand Faith: How Spiritual Relationships Develop Between Consumers and Brands

Kyungin Ryu, Elizabeth G. Miller, D. Matthew Godfrey, Author Notes

Journal of Consumer Research, ucaf055, <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcr/ucaf055>

Published: 09 October 2025

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Abstract

Consumers increasingly seek spiritual satisfaction and existential meaning through brands. However, despite the rising prominence of secular forms of spirituality, consumer-brand relationship research largely overlooks the processes by which consumers initiate, develop, and maintain spiritual connections to brands. Using the concept of faith as a theoretical lens, this paper explores how consumer-brand relationships take on spiritual dimensions. Drawing on an interpretive biographic analysis of in-depth interviews and netnographic data, the authors examine spiritual relationship development processes as they unfold between consumers and brands over time. Findings identify five phases of brand faith development (intuition, association, reflection, affirmation, universalization), which progress from initial attraction to deep conviction. Consumers cultivate faith in brands across these phases through a process of believing in, valuing, and committing to a brand as a sacred entity that acts as a center of spiritual meaning. These findings offer a more nuanced understanding of spiritual relationships between consumers and secular brands than current literature provides. The analysis also examines factors that facilitate or inhibit brand faith development, contributing a contextual understanding of brand faith that accounts for influences arising from an interplay between personal, brand, and marketplace factors that affect consumer spirituality.

Keywords: brand faith, consumer spirituality, consumer-brand relationships, spiritual satisfaction, sacred consumption

Research Context: Consumer Faith in Apple and Tesla



Consumption

- 1) Shopping and consumption is often meaningful
- 2) It makes happy



Mindful consumption: a customer-centric approach to sustainability

Jagdish N. Sheth · Nirmal K. Sethia · Shanthi Srinivas

Received: 31 December 2009 / Accepted: 2 August 2010 / Published online: 17 August 2010
© Academy of Marketing Science 2010

Abstract How effectively business deals with the challenges of sustainability will define its success for decades to come. Current sustainability strategies have three major deficiencies: they do not directly focus on the customer, they do not recognize the looming threats from rising global over-consumption, and they do not take a holistic approach. We present a framework for a customer-centric approach to sustainability. This approach recasts the sustainability metric to emphasize the outcomes of business actions measured holistically in term of environmental, personal and economic well-being of the consumer. We introduce the concept of mindful consumption (MC) as the guiding principle in this approach. MC is premised on a consumer mindset of caring for self, for community, and for nature, that translates behaviorally into tempering the self-defeating excesses associated with acquisitive, repetitive and aspirational consumption. We also make the business case for fostering mindful consumption, and illustrate how the marketing function can be harnessed to successfully implement the customer-centric approach to sustainability.

Keywords Sustainability · Customer-centric sustainability · Mindful consumption

Introduction

Sustainability is today regarded as a vitally important business goal by multiple stakeholders, including investors, customers and policymakers (Epstein and Roy 2003; Hart 2007; Nidumolu et al. 2009; Pfeffer 2010; WBCSD 2008; WEF 2009; Werbach 2009; Worldwatch Institute 2008). Writing in *Harvard Business Review*, Lubin and Esty (2010) characterize sustainability as an “emerging megatrend.” They note that most executives are acutely aware of the profound significance their response to the challenge of sustainability may have for competitiveness, and perhaps even survival, of their organizations.

The term sustainability is defined in many different ways (cf. Hoffman and Bazerman 2007), and has often focused on environmental concerns. The discussion in this paper follows a more comprehensive definition that is gaining worldwide currency. In this definition, sustainability connotes three dimensions: economic, environmental and social (Jackson 2006; National Research Council 1999; Seyfang 2009; WCED 1987). As a business goal, sustainability thus construed, translates into a “triple bottom line” responsibility, with the implication that assessment of business results should be based not only on economic performance, but should take into account the environmental and social impact as well. While this view has its detractors (see for example, Ambec and Lanoie 2008; Crook 2005; Franklin 2008), there is little doubt that leading companies around the world are beginning

Customer-centric sustainability refers to the consumption-mediated impact of marketing actions on environmental, personal and economic well-being of the consumer.

J. N. Sheth
Kellstadt Professor of Marketing, Goizueta Business School,
Emory University,
1300 Clifton Road,
Atlanta, GA 30322, USA
e-mail: jag@jagsheth.com

N. K. Sethia (✉) · S. Srinivas
Professors of Management and Human Resources,
College of Business Administration,
California State Polytechnic University, Pomona,
3801 W. Temple Avenue,

The Evolution of Sustainability Marketing

1

1. Ecological Marketing (1970s)

Sparked by Rachel Carson's Silent Spring. Focus on acute pollution, regulatory compliance (e.g., catalytic converters), and the emergence of the 'Ecologically Concerned Consumer.'

2

2. Environmental Marketing (1980s-90s)

The 'Green Marketing' era. Focus on fulfilling the needs of a new green consumer segment for competitive advantage; sustainable product preferences.

3

3. Sustainable Marketing (2000s-Present)

The Macro-marketing shift. Focus on internalizing environmental costs, building enduring relationships, and collaborating across governments and businesses.

Session 1: Marketing & Consumption

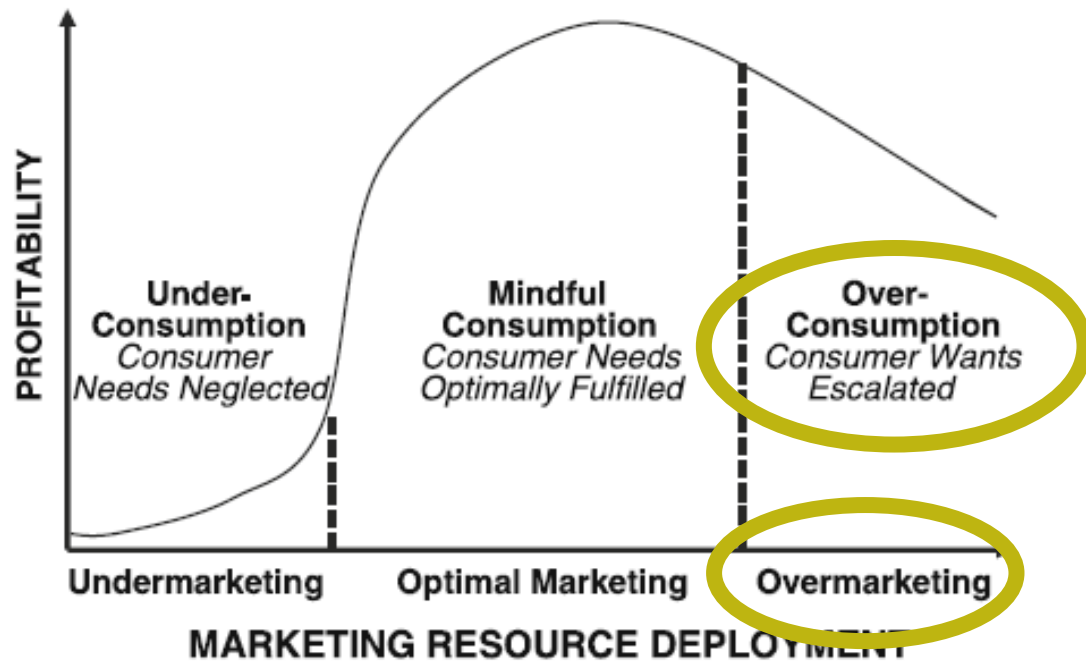


Fig. 2 Marketing, consumption level and profitability



Focus on Well-being

Environmental well-being

health and human well-being consequences of environmental change ensuing from consumption

Personal well-being

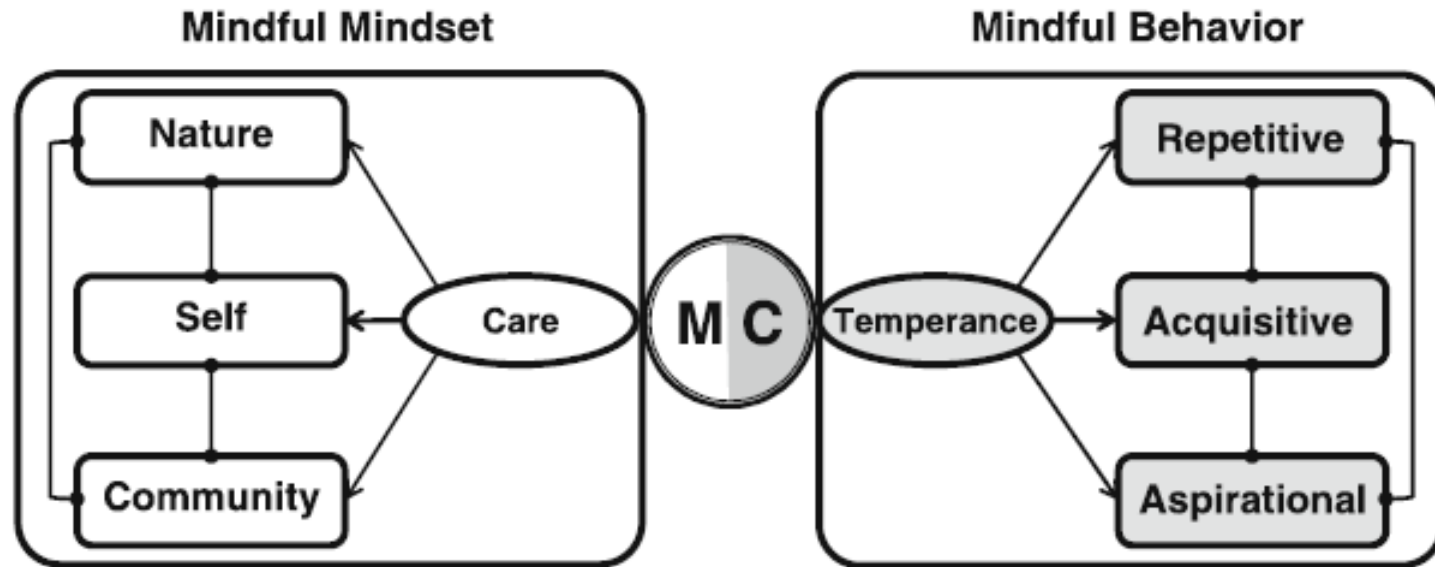
reflecting individual (and family) well-being or quality of life, and associated welfare of the community;

Financial well-being

associated with financial aspects such as debt-burden, earning pressures, and work-life balance



i-frame (versus s-frame)



Target Article

Cite this article: Chater N, Loewenstein G. (2023) The i-frame and the s-frame: How focusing on individual-level solutions has led behavioral public policy astray. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences* 46, e147: 1–84. doi:10.1017/S0140525X22002023

Target Article Accepted: 23 August 2022
Target Article Manuscript Online: 5 September 2022

Commentaries Accepted: 21 February 2023

Keywords:

addition; behavior change; behavioral economics; behavioral public policy; climate change; framing; nudges; obesity

What is Open Peer Commentary? What follows on these pages is known as a Treatment, in which a significant and controversial Target Article is published along with Commentaries (p. 25) and an Authors' Response (p. 75). See [bpsonline.org](https://www.bpsonline.org) for more information.

The i-frame and the s-frame: How focusing on individual-level solutions has led behavioral public policy astray

Nick Chater^a and George Loewenstein^b

^aBehavioural Science Group, Warwick Business School, University of Warwick, Coventry, UK and ^bDepartment of Social and Decision Sciences, Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA, USA

nick.chater@wbs.ac.uk; <https://www.wbs.ac.uk/about/person/nick-chater/>
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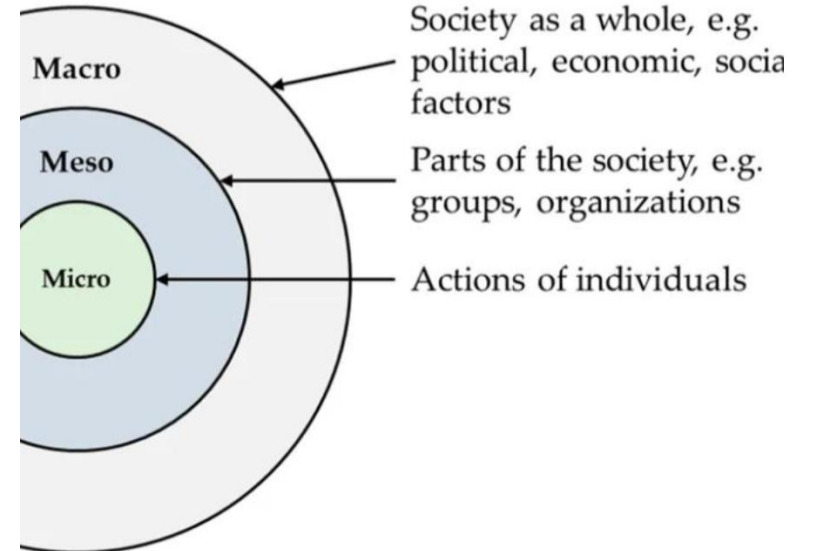
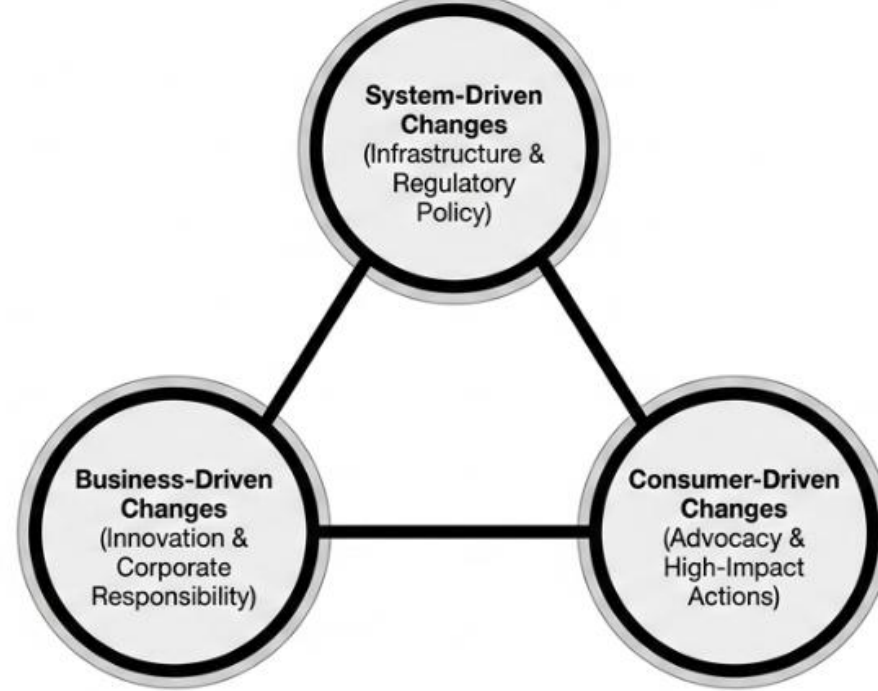
Abstract

An influential line of thinking in behavioral science, to which the two authors have long subscribed, is that many of society's most pressing problems can be addressed cheaply and effectively at the level of the individual, without modifying the system in which the individual operates. We now believe this was a mistake, along with, we suspect, many colleagues in both the academic and policy communities. Results from such interventions have been disappointingly modest. But more importantly, they have guided many (though by no means all) behavioral scientists to frame policy problems in individual, not systemic, terms: To adopt what we call the "i-frame," rather than the "s-frame." The difference may be more consequential than i-frame advocates have realized, by deflecting attention and support away from s-frame policies. Indeed, highlighting the i-frame is a long-established objective of corporate opponents of concerted systemic action such as regulation and taxation. We illustrate our argument briefly for six policy problems, and in depth with the examples of climate change, obesity, retirement savings, and pollution from plastic waste. We argue that the most important way in which behavioral scientists can contribute to public policy is by employing their skills to develop and implement value-creating system-level change.

1. The i-frame and the s-frame

The behavioral and brain sciences primarily focus on what we call the i-frame: On *individuals*, and their thoughts and behaviors. Public policy, by contrast, typically focuses on the s-frame: The *system* of rules, norms, and institutions usually studied by economists, sociologists, legal scholars, and political scientists.

Historically, i-frame insights engage with public policy through evidence about which s-frame policies will work. Thus, research on neural and cognitive mechanisms of imitation has been linked to the impacts of media violence (Bandura, Ross, & Ross, 1963; Hurley, 2004). The neuroscience and psychology of addiction has informed the regulation of recreational drugs, cigarettes, alcohol, and gambling (Robinson & Berridge, 2000; Verdejo-Garcia et al., 2019; Volkow & Boyle, 2018). Health psychologists, epidemiologists, and public health doctors have studied the physiological and neurological mechanisms that convert s-frame fac-



The past, present, and future of sustainability marketing: How did we get here and where might we go?

Katherine White^{a,b,c}, Aylin Cakanlar^{b,d}, Shakti Sethi^a, Remi Trudel^e

^a University of British Columbia, Canada

^b Frankfurt School of Finance & Management, Germany

^c Boston University, United States

^d Center for Retailing, Stockholm School of Economics, Sweden

ARTICLE INFO

Keywords:
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Bio-diversity consumer behavior
History
Future
Review

ABSTRACT

The ever-increasing concerns about global sustainability have sparked intense debates and actions across various sectors, with marketing playing a pivotal role in influencing both the problem and potential solutions. This article maps the historical trajectory of sustainability marketing, analyzes current trends, and explores future directions to enhance sustainability within marketing practice. We show that sustainability marketing has historically centered on resource conservation and green marketing, but its recent years in scope has expanded to encompass a broader range of topics. These include the circular economy, anti-consumption, regulatory frameworks, innovation, carbon emissions, as well as the social and ethical considerations inherent in sustainability marketing. We propose three main areas within which sustainability marketing might expand in the future: system-driven changes, business-driven changes, and consumer-driven changes. Our analysis aims to deepen the understanding of sustainability marketing and inspire marketers to explore questions and solutions that will contribute to a sustainable future.

1. Introduction

"We live now...in a 'Full World,' with an economy that exceeds Earth's regenerative and absorptive capacity by over-harvesting resources such as fish and forests, and over-filling sinks such as the atmosphere and oceans."

—Kate Raworth, 2017.

can regenerate and support (Footprint Network.org, 2023). Each year, this day arrives sooner and sooner, and, at the time of this writing, we currently exceed the planet's resource capacity in early August. Right now, humanity is using nature's resources 1.7 times faster than the planet can regenerate and sustain. Notably, if the entire globe were to adopt the consumption and lifestyle habits of a country such as the USA, we would need more than 5 planet Earths to sustain this level of resource



What happens

scientific reports

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OPEN Secondhand fashion consumers exhibit fast fashion behaviors despite sustainability narratives

Meital Peleg Mizrahi^{1,3} & Ori Sharon^{2,3}

The fashion industry contributes 2–8% of global greenhouse gas emissions, driven by rising clothing consumption and the proliferation of fast fashion. Fast fashion accelerates environmental harm through rapid production cycles, low costs, and short garment lifespans. Secondhand clothing markets are often promoted as a sustainable alternative, promising extended use and reduced waste. These markets have grown rapidly, with global sales reaching \$177 billion in 2022 and projected to double by 2027. Despite this growth, few studies have empirically examined whether secondhand purchasing displaces or merely supplements primary market consumption. This study addresses that gap using a nationally representative survey of 1,009 U.S. consumers. We find that secondhand consumption is positively correlated with new clothing purchases ($r=0.58$, $p<0.01$), particularly among younger consumers and frequent shoppers. Cluster and principal component analyses reveal that highly engaged secondhand consumers also exhibit high overall consumption and short garment retention. Although many report high sustainability knowledge, such knowledge does not reliably predict sustainable behavior. Drawing on rebound and moral licensing theories, we suggest that secondhand purchases may psychologically or economically justify continued overconsumption. These findings challenge assumptions about resale's environmental benefits and support policy interventions to realign resale practices with sustainability goals.

Keywords Sustainable fashion, Second-Hand clothing, Rebound effect, Moral licensing, Overconsumption.

Rebound or reduction?? The sustainability promise and pitfalls of secondhand fashion

The fashion industry ranks among the most environmentally damaging sectors globally^{1–4}. Amid growing concerns over its environmental and social impacts, secondhand markets have emerged as a purportedly sustainable alternative. Promoted by fashion brands, sustainability-oriented firms, consumers, and policymakers alike, resale platforms and garment collection programs are increasingly framed as tools for reducing waste and extending product lifespans within circular economy frameworks⁵.

Despite this momentum, the environmental efficacy of secondhand fashion remains underexamined. Although resale markets have expanded rapidly⁶ it is unclear whether secondhand purchases displace new clothing consumption or merely supplement it⁷. If the latter, resale might inadvertently reinforce overconsumption rather than mitigate it. Behavioral theories such as the rebound effect and moral licensing complicate the sustainability

opinie

Willemijn van Dolen | Should we become more or less attached to our stuff?



Willemijn van Dolen, 19 maart 2025 - 12:33

About UvA Marketing Duurzaamheid

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We love our stuff, so we take better care of it, research shows. But why do we get more easily attached to new purchases and more quickly let go of second-hand stuff? Columnist Willemijn van Dolen writes about this tricky paradox.

From Second-Hand to Third-Hand: Reuse and Resale Cycle

FEIFEI HUANG
VINCENT CHI WONG

The promotion of reuse and resale has been receiving extensive attention worldwide for the sake of sustainability. The current research provides insights into this area and identifies a "reuse and resale cycle," whereby consumers are more willing to resell products they originally obtained second hand, compared to products they obtained brand new. One potential mechanism that accounts for this effect is the relatively weak connection consumers form with the second-hand items they own. Six studies confirmed this effect across various product categories. Study 1 tracked consumers' actual resale of the possessions they owned in real life. Subsequent studies provided further empirical evidence for the proposed effect, uncovered the underlying mechanism concerning the strength of the connection with the product, and showed that the effect diminished among consumers who chronically have a high tendency to link themselves with their possessions. This research advances the understanding of resale behaviors. It has implications for consumers to avoid retaining excessive possessions and for the second-hand market to develop in a healthy manner, eventually contributing to society's sustainability in the long run.

Keywords: sustainability, resale behavior, second-hand products, connection with possessions

The long-term responsible use of energy and resources to achieve sustainable development has been listed by the United Nations as one of the most pressing issues

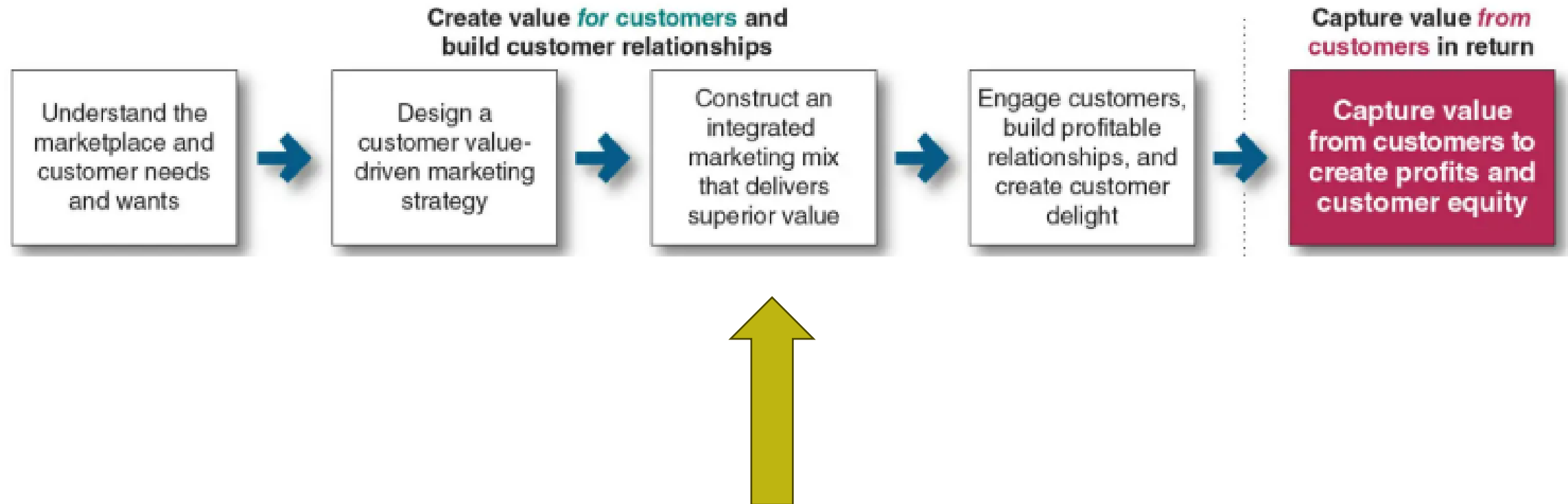
Feifei Huang (feifei.huang@polyu.edu.hk) is an assistant professor of

facing the world in the next five decades (United Nations 2022). Therefore, the promotion of reuse and resale behaviors has been receiving extensive attention worldwide. Such behaviors can reduce waste as well as save energy and resources in the production of new goods for society, and at the same time create happiness for consumers

Downloaded from https://academic.oup.com/scientificreports/15/1/10447/722983 by Universiteit van Amsterdam 1



The Marketing Process: Creating + Capturing Customer





Facilitating Consumption -> 4 P's

- 1) Product;
- 2) Price;
- 3) Promotion;
- 4) Place;

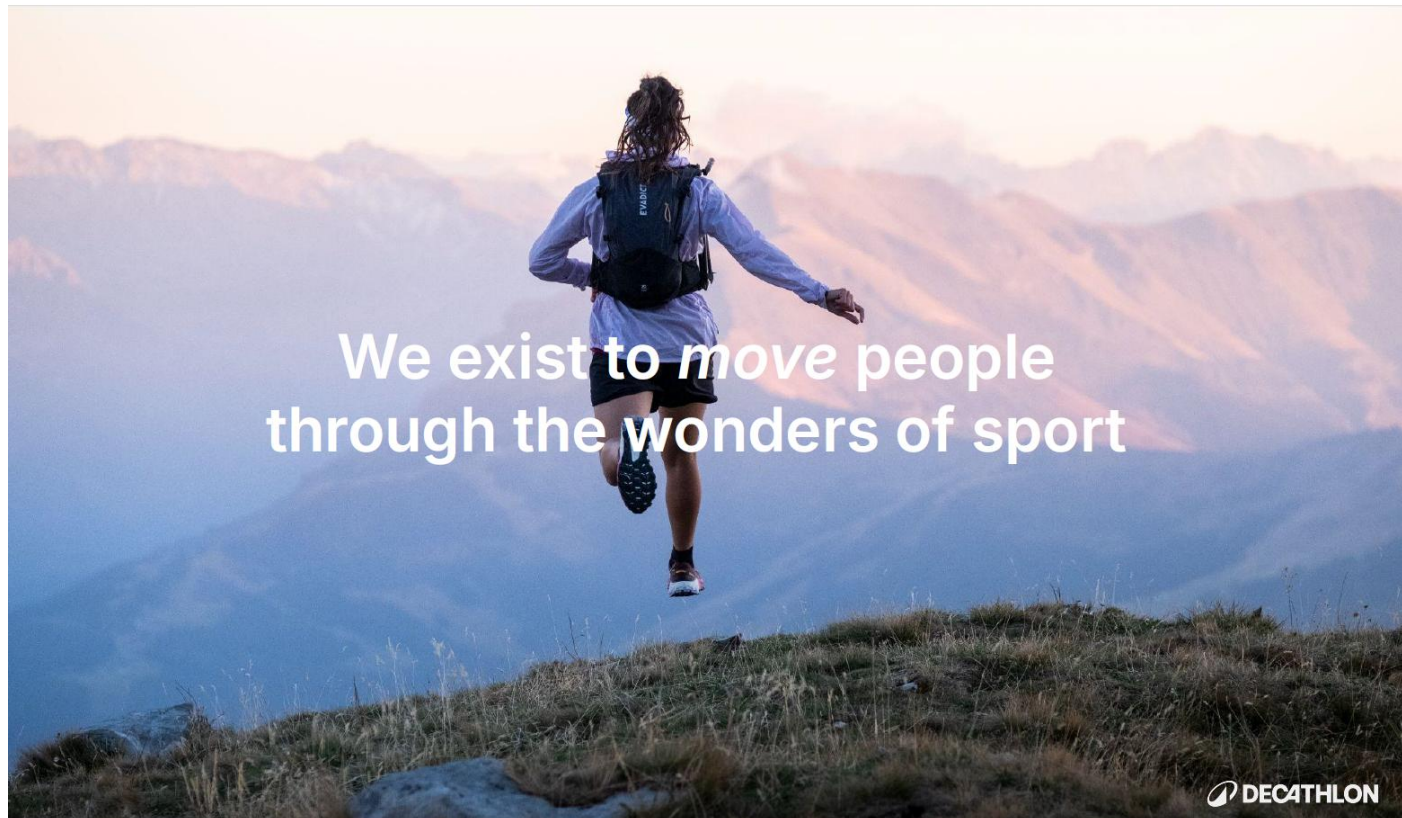


4 P's

- 1) Product; valuable, durable, easy to upgrade, offer repair services, share the product, is it good enough to recycle or to sell it, low on resources
- 2) Price; does the price fully internalize the environmental and social costs? Are products priced so that overconsumption is discouraged?
- 3) Promotion; focus on sustainable lifestyles? Or on acquisitive, repetitive, and aspirational behavior? Transparent and fair?
- 4) Place; easy access to service and repairs, reuse and sharing?



Decathlon: Customer Centrality





WB (environmental, personal, financial)

Environmental 

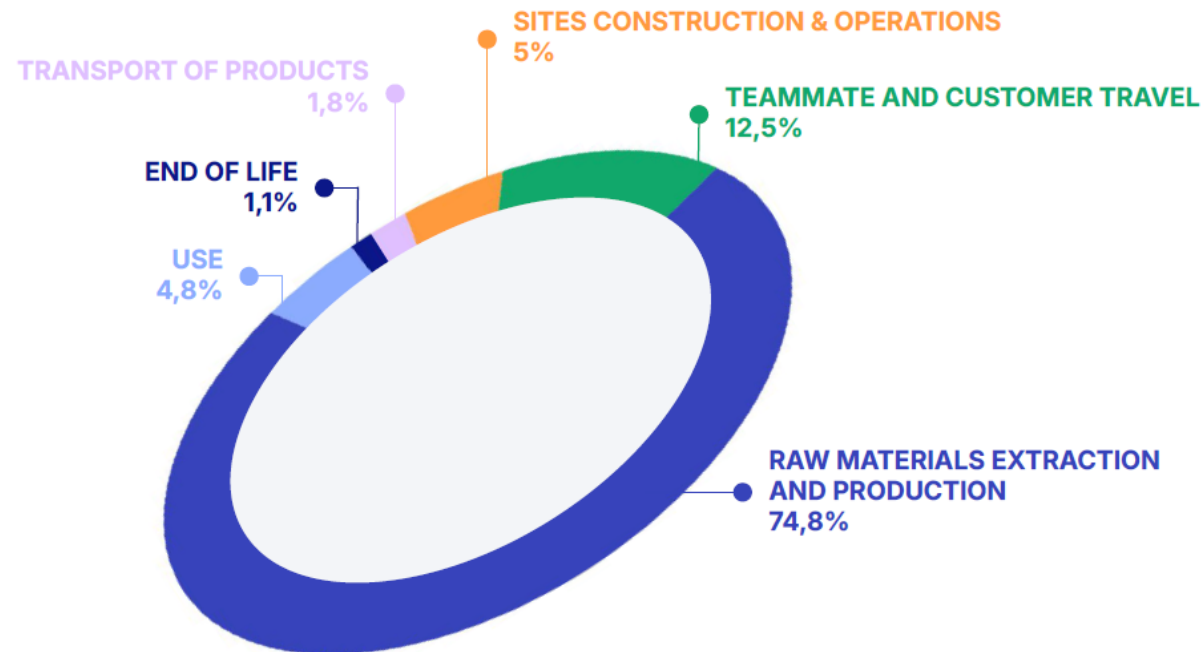
Personal 

Financial 



4 P's: Product

Our products define 82,5% of our total CO2e footprint

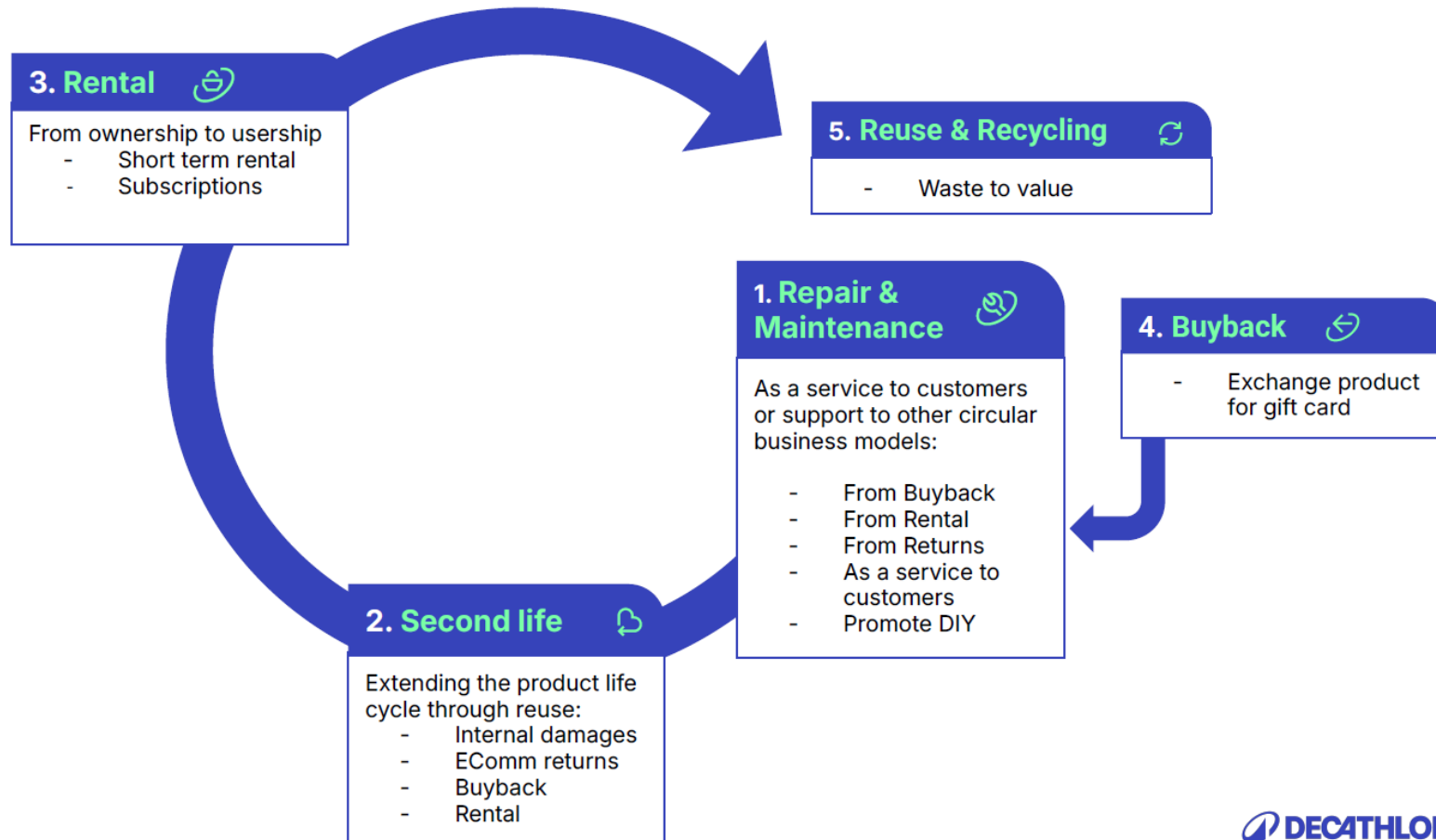


2023 NFRD figures

Note: IT is not included as it represents 0.2%



5 New Circular Business Model



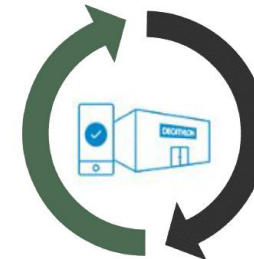
New Circular Business Models

Within our services, we can distinguish two types of customer behavior



Within our services, we can distinguish two types of customer behavior

Here, we need to create new consumption habits



Here, we only change the message & add an extra option



It didn't work, Buy Back

Value giftcard:

- With product to the store: hassle
- Value of the giftcard is too low; people miss external motivation to use the service
- Pay for parking/Public transport

Competence:

- People don't know or do not understand how it works
- The online experience showed bugs and offline the process heavily depends on the store and the employee who helps
- Waiting at the helpdesk/customer service.



Product, Price, Promotion and Place

Discover Buyback, Repair and Second life

Trade in your tent for a gift card through Buyback, and we'll give it a second life. Is your tent broken but still want to keep it going? Let us repair it! Or are you still looking for a tent? Also check out our Second Life selection. These tents have been inspected and refurbished by experts, come with a one-year warranty, and are sold at a lower price than new.



SECOND-HAND
CAMPING
EQUIPMENT



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Rent your tent at the festivals Onder de radar, Wildeburg and Wilde Weide

At three festivals this year—Onder de Radar, Wildeburg, and Wilde Weide—you can rent our 2 seconds fresh & black tent and a party tent. It's cheaper than buying one, and you don't have to transport your tent to and from the festival yourself. You can rent your tent through the organizers of these festivals.



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Product

Good examples for different dying method

Comparator - Water bottle

Game on,
impact down



Wist je dat door deze print weg te laten, we de CO₂-afdruk van de fles met 10,1% verlagen?



Product

NO DYEING, LESS IMPACT. IT'S AS SIMPLE AS THAT.

Conventional industrial dyes require a large amount of water that must be brought to a high temperature, which consumes a lot of electricity. However, electricity production emits a significant amount of CO₂, especially when coal-based. In short, choosing undyed products allows to save energy and to limit water consumption.

To further reduce our carbon footprint, we have identified three other levers:

- Minimising product manufacturing thanks to rental and second-hand products
- Relocating production to countries with low-carbon energy sources
- Continuing to ensure that our dyeing factories are connected to efficient wastewater treatment plants





Product: Recycle



Turning textile waste
into new adventures
through recycling

From old plastic bottle recycling, we give discarded textiles a new purpose by turning them into recycled polyester and keeping valuable materials in use.

Product made from 85% recycled polyester from textile waste.

How to return worn shoes?

1. Prepare your shoes
2. Make a shoe box
3. Place the shoes in the box and add the shoe insert
4. Place the box in the shoe box

How to return worn shoes?





Next step

SHIFT

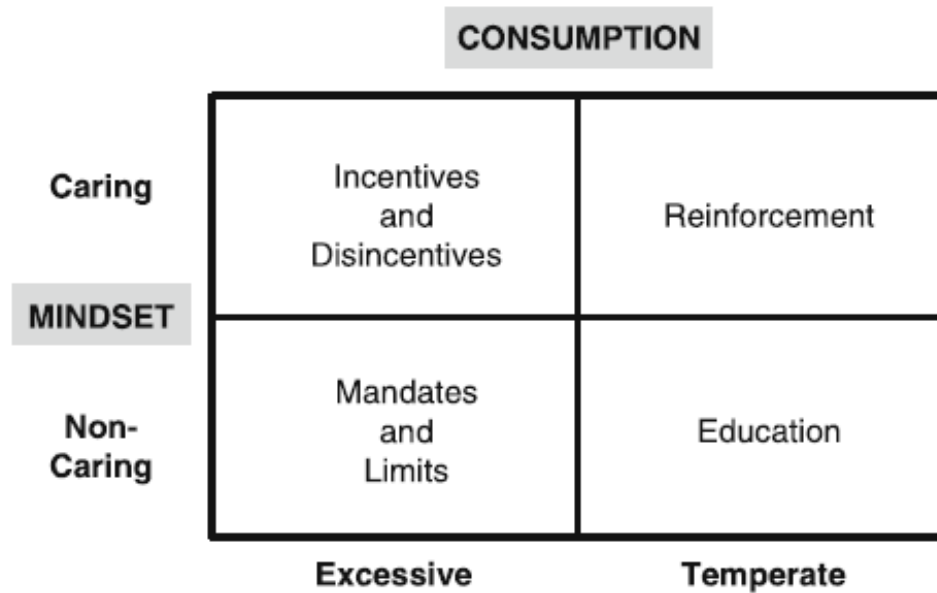


Fig. 3 Advancing mindful consumption



Tools

Article



How to SHIFT Consumer Behaviors to be More Sustainable: A Literature Review and Guiding Framework

Katherine White¹, Rishad Habib, and David J. Hardisty

Abstract

Highlighting the important role of marketing in encouraging sustainable consumption, the current research presents a review of the academic literature from marketing and behavioral science that examines the most effective ways to shift consumer behaviors to be more sustainable. In the process of the review, the authors develop a comprehensive framework for conceptualizing and encouraging sustainable consumer behavior change. The framework is represented by the acronym SHIFT, and it proposes that consumers are more inclined to engage in pro-environmental behaviors when the message or context leverages the following psychological factors: Social influence, Habit formation, Individual self, Feelings and cognition, and Tangibility. The authors also identify five broad challenges

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- Why & How?

“as technologies and societies change, practitioners can easily apply our framework to new situations” and “a key contribution is that we offer a comprehensive set of tools”



FIGURE 3.

TOOLS: SOCIAL INFLUENCE

TOOL

1

Social norms

- Use social norms to communicate what others are doing and approve of the desired sustainable consumer behaviour.
- Show relevant others or in-group members using the product or service, or engaging in the sustainable action.

TOOL

2

Social
desirability

- Have the desired action be something that is performed in social contexts, especially if it is viewed positively by others.
- Create socially desirable (and avoid undesirable) associations with the product, service or pro-social action.

TOOL

3

Social group
membership

- Associate the sustainable product, service or behaviour with a positively viewed in-group.
- Consider fostering healthy competition between groups to encourage sustainable actions.



Social influence



First part of the course

Evolutionary bases of behavior

(Griskevicius et al 2012)

Goals:

- *Proximate*: Culture, incentives, preferences, learning, utility, pleasure, values, personality, etc.
- *Ultimate*: Evolutionary bases.

Mismatches between current and ancestral:

1. Propensity of self-interest
2. Motivation for relative rather than absolute status 
3. Proclivity to unconsciously copy others 
4. Predisposition to be short-sighted
5. Proneness to disregard impalpable concerns



FIGURE 4.

TOOLS: HABIT FORMATION

TOOLS TO BREAK BAD HABITS

TOOL

1

Discontinuity

- Ask people to change their habits during context shifts.
- Big moves such as house relocation, starting a new job, etc. are a good time to try to get people to start new habits.

TOOL

2

Penalties

- Consider using penalties only if you can monitor and enforce the programme.
- If you use penalties, don't use penalties that are considered to be extreme or unfair.



Habit formation

TOOLS TO FOSTER GOOD HABITS

TOOL

1

Make it easy

- Make the sustainable behaviour less costly, less effortful or easier to do.
- Set green behaviours and options to be the default choice.

TOOL

2

Incentives

- Provide non-monetary incentives such as gifts or tokens and/or large monetary incentives such as the chance to win prize money.
- Be careful when giving monetary incentives because this can backfire if the savings are small and can discourage altruistic motives.

TOOL

3

Prompts

- Use prompts to remind people to engage in the desired sustainable consumer behaviour.
- Ensure that prompts are noticeable, clear and in close proximity to where the actual behaviour will be carried out.

TOOL

4

Feedback

- Give frequent and regular feedback over a long period.
- Present the feedback clearly and appealingly.
- Provide individualised real-time feedback when possible rather than comparative peer feedback when in a non-group setting.

The average adult makes 33.000 to 35.000 total decisions each day. (<https://hbr.org/2023/12/a-simple-way-to-make-better-decisions>)



Keep the Habit

NO DYEING, LESS IMPACT. IT'S AS SIMPLE AS THAT.

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impact down



Wist je dat door deze print weg te laten, we de CO₂-afdruk van de fles met 10,1% verlagen?



Turning textile waste into new adventures through recycling

By using plastic bottle recycling, we give discarded bottles a new purpose by turning them into recycled polyester and sewing it into our materials.

Product made from 35% recycled polyester from plastic waste.

How to reduce your impact?

- 1. Buy second-hand
- 2. Buy local
- 3. Buy from brands that use recycled materials
- 4. Buy from brands that use sustainable materials
- 5. Buy from brands that use sustainable materials

More information on our website

DECATHLON

Alternative



FIGURE 5.

TOOLS: INDIVIDUAL SELF

TOOL

1

Personal norms

- Appeal to those with strong personal norms related to sustainability.
- Activate relevant personal norms by reminding consumers of moral or pro-social obligations to act in a sustainable manner.

TOOL

2

Positivity of the self-concept

- Allow the behaviour or product to have positive associations for the self.
- Connect the self-concept to the product, service or behaviour in some way.



Individual self

TOOL

3

Self-consistency

- Encourage consumers to engage in sustainable consumer behaviours that are consistent with their own beliefs, values and previous actions.
- Encourage commitments to engage in sustainable behaviours.
- Avoid licensing effects by asking for meaningful commitments and linking behaviours to deeply held values.

TOOL

4

Self-interest

- Appeal to self-interest, especially in ways that overcome barriers related to the sustainable product, service or behaviour.
- Combine appeals to self-interest with other tools.

TOOL

5

Self-efficacy

- Make consumers feel that they can engage in the desired sustainable consumer behaviour.
- Highlight how the desired behaviour can make a meaningful impact.
- Consider the interplay between self-interest (degree of consumer compromise) and efficacy (confidence in being able to make a difference).

TOOL

6

Individual differences

- Take into account individual differences in terms of personality, values and demographics.
- Appeal to consumers who are oriented towards sustainability, but also to those for whom the product, service or behaviour will resonate.



What's in it for me?

PLANTBASED EATING

OUR MOTIVATION

- Less animal suffering
- Lower climate impact
- Less water/land use
- Fairer food system

WIFFM

- Safer food
- Less food poisoning
- Healthier choice
- Adventurous (trying new things)
- Eat like a local (in some destinations)



What's in it for me?

TRAIN (INSTEAD OF FLYING)

OUR MOTIVATION

- Trains emit significantly less CO₂ than planes
- Avoids air pollution and contrails that intensify climate impact
- Encourages slow travel and regional discovery → less pressure on long-haul destinations

WIFFM

- No airport stress, security lines, or baggage restrictions
- More comfort and legroom
- Stopovers in unique cities along the way
- Experience the changing of landscape
- WiFi on board



Habits – Social Influence – Self-interest

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FIGURE 6.

TOOLS: FEELINGS AND COGNITION

TOOL

1

Feelings

- Activate individual feelings of guilt but do so in subtle ways to avoid reactance effects.
- Be aware that explicit guilt appeals can backfire.
- Activate feelings of fear and negative affect, but also highlight a sense of self-efficacy and what steps people could take next.
- Use anticipated and collective guilt to motivate actions.
- Encourage consumers to feel a sense of pride in their positive past behaviours.
- Focus on actions that reduce the danger to activate hope and minimise fear and anger.

TOOL

2

Cognition

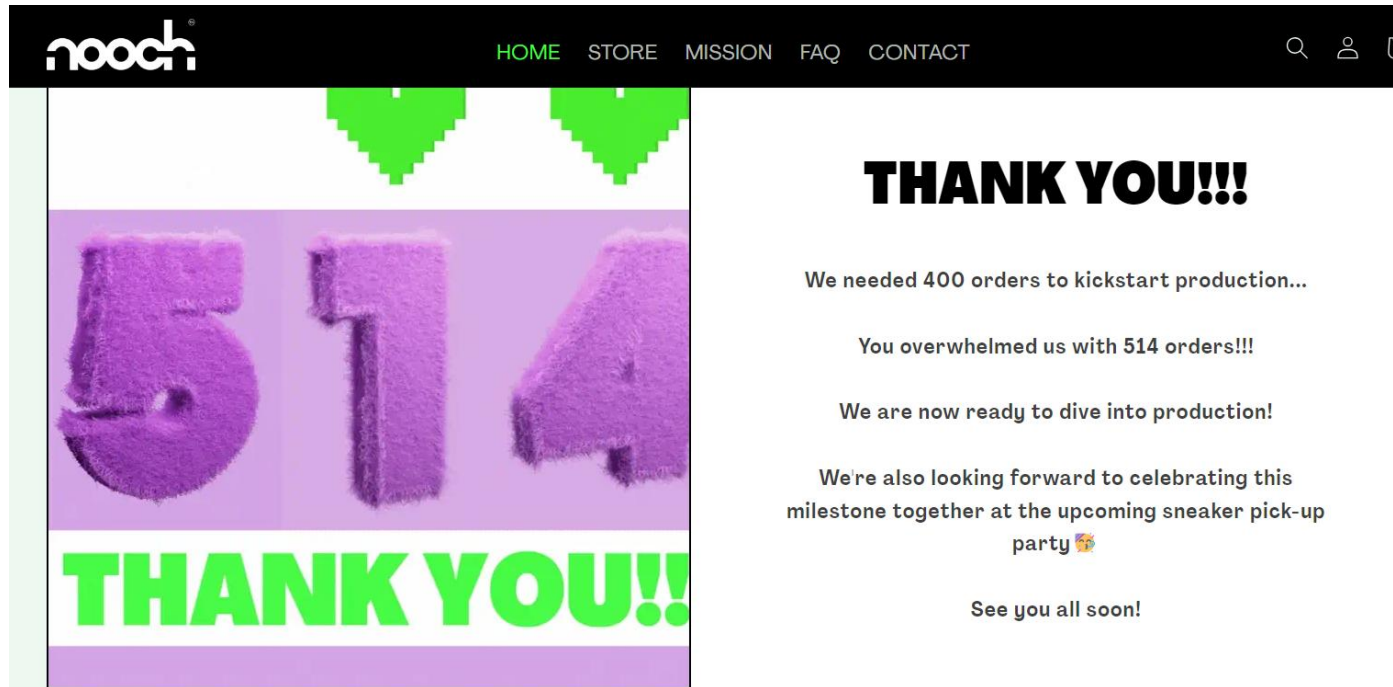
- Provide information to consumers, in concert with using other behaviour change tactics.
- Use eco-labelling, especially information that is third-party certified.
- Employ loss framing, especially linked with concrete information.



Feelings and cognition



Feelings: Hope





Cognition

Creating Awareness



To search

To play sports Gentlemen Ladies Children Sports accessories Sportswear Sports shoes Sale



Go for sports gear that already knows the game

At Decathlon, we love our products. They give us so much, so it's up to us to give something back. Take care of your products and let them go for another round. Or choose sports products that already know the game.

The programs below help us extend the lifespan of our products. For example, you can trade in a used product for a Decathlon gift card through Buyback, rent a product or subscribe to a children's bike subscription through Rental, repair your product (or have it repaired) through Repair, and finally, buy used products through our Second Life offering.

Second life

Tweedehands
producten

Buyback

Ruil je gebruikte
product in voor
een giftcard

Maintain & Repair

Je producten
repareren

Rental

Waarom kopen als je
ook kunt huren?



FIGURE 7.

TOOLS: TANGIBILITY

TOOL

1

— **Future benefits**

- Remind consumers to be more future-focused, to match the future focus on sustainable actions.

TOOL

2

— **Local impacts**

- Frame sustainable actions as local and proximal. Refer to local (versus global) impacts of actions and outcomes.

TOOL

3

— **Concrete communications**

- Highlight the specific outcomes and steps consumers can take.
- Highlight the impacts of acting and not acting in ways that are self-relevant to the consumer.
- Use vivid imagery.
- Use analogies to communicate impacts and outcomes.
- Use clear graphs to display issues and outcomes.

TOOL

4

— **Desire for intangibles**

- Encourage the desire for intangibles such as experiences, services and digital goods over the ownership of material goods.



Tangibility



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Na 40 jaar weer de eerste augurken uit Nederland!!! @kesbeke plantte ze dit jaar in Drenthe en daar moest ik natuurlijk even langs met @Camielkes! Vind ze in de schappen!
#kesbeke #augurk #boeren #oogst
See translation

For you



jennynolting 46w
Reply



dellys_twisted 48w
Heerlijk 2
amsterdammers....mooi gefilmd...das informatief heel



3,444 likes

October 27, 2024



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Yumeko

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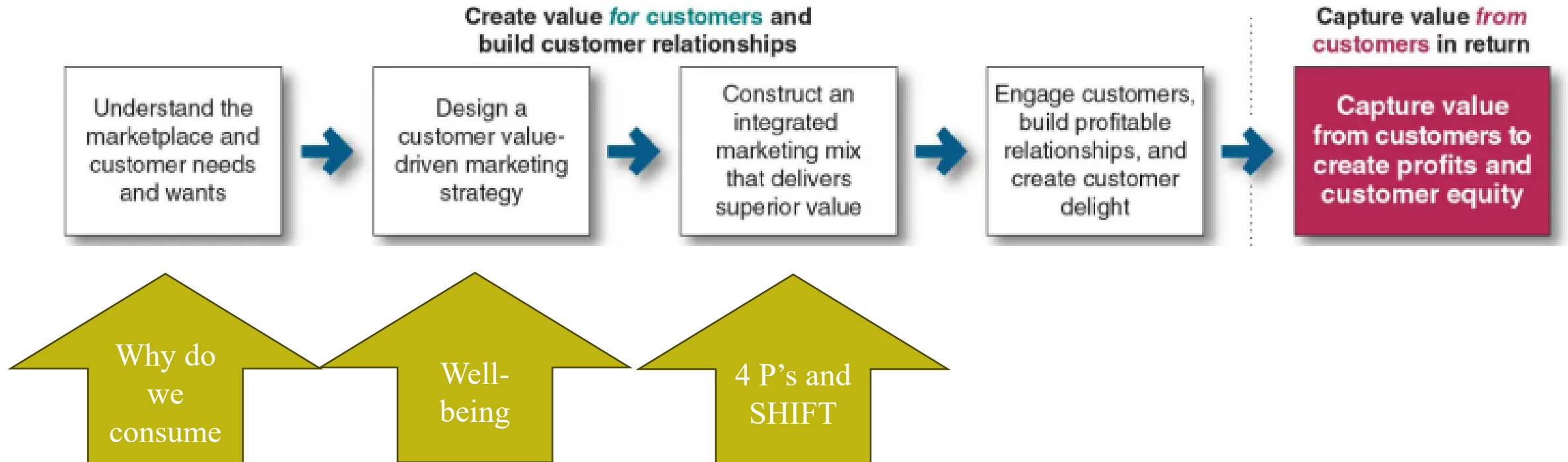


Bath linen Clothing Blankets Accessories Kids Sale Stories





RECAP





Next Session

- 1) STEP 3 (and questions about STEP 2)
- 2) Camiel Kesbeke



Questions?





Please fill in your attendance

[Attendance link](#)